

The 65€ Budget Commander Challenge

Willkommen. Bienvenue. Welcome.

Mesdames et messieurs, ladies and gentlemen, Damen und Herren —

Come in. Sit down. Leave your expensive staples at the door.

Here, in this little Commander format, we do not ask *what is the best deck you can build*. We ask something far more interesting: **what can you do with 65 euros, a color combination you did not choose, and a commander nobody saw coming?**

You see, in the outside world, players spend hundreds on their decks. They tutor for the same cards. They play the same commanders. How... *boring*.

But here? Here we have *rules*. Here we have *drama*. One player whispers a wedge into your ear like a secret. And you — oh, you poor, wonderful, creative soul — must build something magnificent from whatever scraps that wedge allows. No Demonic Tutors. No famous generals riding to your rescue. Just your wits, your collection, and sixty-five euros.

The money is not the point, of course. The point is the constraint. The point is the reveal. The point is sitting down across from three other people who were all given a cage and asked to make art inside it.

So. Are you ready to play?

Then let us begin.

How a Challenge Works

1. Challengers and challenged players are assigned randomly (Secret Santa draw).
2. The **challenger** picks any of the 10 three-color wedges and presents it to their assigned challenged player. **Deadline: 10 days after the Secret Santa is drawn.**

3. The **challenged** chooses any color combination *within* that wedge — mono-color, two-color, or the full three — and builds a deck respecting all rules below.
4. On game night, everyone reveals their commander and brew, and all four players sit down and play.

Deck submission deadline: August 1st, 2026. You have two options: - Submit a **Moxfield decklist link** before the deadline, plus a screenshot of the Moxfield price total at the time of brewing to prove the budget constraint was met. - Alternatively, bring a **screenshot of your Moxfield decklist** to the first match session showing the price at time of brewing. You then reveal your commander and deck on the spot.

The Rules

Budget: 65 €

The total cost of the deck may not exceed **65 €**. Price is determined by the **Moxfield decklist total using the cheapest available printing** of each card. Basic lands are free and do not count toward the budget.

Color Wedge

The challenger assigns a three-color wedge. The challenged may build with **any color combination contained within that wedge** — but cannot play a colorless commander.

For example, if the assigned wedge is **Jund (Black/Red/Green)**, valid commander color identities are:

- Mono-Black, Mono-Red, or Mono-Green
- Rakdos (BR), Golgari (BG), or Gruul (RG)
- Full Jund (BRG)

The commander defines the deck's color identity as usual — cards in the 99 must fall within the commander's colors.

Commander Ban: Top 10 by Popularity

To prevent the most obvious choices, the **top 10 EDHREC commanders** for the chosen color combination are banned as the commander. The list below is a snapshot taken on 2026-06-01 and is locked for this challenge — live rankings don't affect it.

This ban applies only to the commander slot — those cards can still appear in the 99 if they are legal in the deck's color identity and fit the budget.

Mono-White (W)

#	Commander	Decks
1	Giada, Font of Hope	31,594
2	Light-Paws, Emperor's Voice	11,595
3	Anti-Venom, Horrifying Healer	9,592
4	Myrel, Shield of Argive	8,150
5	Elesh Norn, Mother of Machines	7,446
6	Cloud, Midgar Mercenary	6,958
7	Delney, Streetwise Lookout	6,223
8	Heliod, Sun-Crowned	4,927
9	Odric, Lunarch Marshal	4,613
10	Darien, King of Kjeldor	4,404

Mono-Blue (U)

#	Commander	Decks
1	Urza, Lord High Artificer	19,186
2	Eluge, the Shoreless Sea	13,961
3	The Mindskinner	11,514
4	Orvar, the All-Form	10,157
5	Bruvac the Grandiloquent	7,225
6	Talrand, Sky Summoner	6,658
7	Minn, Wily Illusionist	6,212
8	Emry, Lurker of the Loch	6,151
9	Vnwxt, Verbose Host	6,107
10	Baral, Chief of Compliance	5,323

Mono-Black (B)

#	Commander	Decks
1	Sephiroth, Fabled SOLDIER	25,476
2	K'rrik, Son of Yawgmoth	19,735
3	Marrow-Gnawer	13,564
4	Tergrid, God of Fright	11,939

#	Commander	Decks
5	Sheoldred, the Apocalypse	11,414
6	Tinybones, Bauble Burglar	9,167
7	Braids, Arisen Nightmare	8,247
8	Imotekh the Stormlord	7,811
9	Shirei, Shizo's Caretaker	7,310
10	Maha, Its Feathers Night	6,906

Mono-Red (R)

#	Commander	Decks
1	Krenko, Mob Boss	40,679
2	Magda, Brazen Outlaw	16,669
3	Zada, Hedron Grinder	13,091
4	Ojer Axonil, Deepest Might	10,446
5	Alexios, Deimos of Kosmos	8,964
6	Tannuk, Steadfast Second	8,789
7	Norin the Wary	8,050
8	Kratos, God of War	7,590
9	Imodane, the Pyrohammer	6,685
10	Clive, Ifrit's Dominant	6,130

Mono-Green (G)

#	Commander	Decks
1	Fynn, the Fangbearer	15,201
2	Tifa Lockhart	12,687
3	Shroofus Sproutsire	10,911
4	Kona, Rescue Beastie	10,310
5	Omnath, Locus of Mana	9,193
6	Gargos, Vicious Watcher	8,566
7	Ghalta, Primal Hunger	8,170
8	Marwyn, the Nurturer	7,961
9	Lumra, Bellow of the Woods	7,536
10	Bristly Bill, Spine Sower	7,457

Azorius (WU)

#	Commander	Decks
1	Shorikai, Genesis Engine	20,058
2	Hope Estheim	15,241
3	Mendicant Core, Guidelight	14,820
4	Brago, King Eternal	13,851
5	Grand Arbiter Augustin IV	12,770
6	Hylde of the Icy Crown	11,901
7	Kastral, the Windcrested	9,802
8	Niko, Light of Hope	9,292
9	Millicent, Restless Revenant	7,046
10	Kwain, Itinerant Meddler	6,706

Dimir (UB)

#	Commander	Decks
1	Yuriko, the Tiger's Shadow	31,077
2	Wilhelm, the Rotcleaver	21,698
3	Captain N'ghathrod	17,403
4	Alela, Cunning Conqueror	16,765
5	Satoru Umezawa	13,922
6	Lord of the Nazgûl	13,726
7	The Scarab God	13,565
8	Vren, the Relentless	12,697
9	Jon Irenicus, Shattered One	11,710
10	Golbez, Crystal Collector	10,146

Rakdos (BR)

#	Commander	Decks
1	Valgavoth, Harrower of Souls	27,555
2	Kuja, Genome Sorcerer	18,040
3	Deadpool, Trading Card	15,562
4	Prosper, Tome-Bound	13,530
5	Judith, Carnage Connoisseur	11,739
6	Gev, Scaled Scorch	11,297

#	Commander	Decks
7	The Infamous Cruelclaw	10,413
8	Shadow the Hedgehog	10,241
9	Ob Nixilis, Captive Kingpin	10,121
10	Rakdos, Lord of Riots	9,734

Gruul (RG)

#	Commander	Decks
1	Bello, Bard of the Brambles	25,477
2	Etali, Primal Conqueror	15,782
3	Tovolar, Dire Overlord	14,886
4	Kibo, Uktabi Prince	13,468
5	Wolverine, Best There Is	10,852
6	Roxanne, Starfall Savant	9,187
7	Omnath, Locus of Rage	8,758
8	Minsc & Boo, Timeless Heroes	8,660
9	Raggadragga, Goreguts Boss	8,654
10	Xenagos, God of Revels	7,908

Selesnya (GW)

#	Commander	Decks
1	Sythis, Harvest's Hand	13,596
2	Arahbo, Roar of the World	10,628
3	Kudo, King Among Bears	9,593
4	Finneas, Ace Archer	8,306
5	Ellivere of the Wild Court	8,012
6	Gluntch, the Bestower	7,373
7	Lathiel, the Bounteous Dawn	6,996
8	Sigarda, Font of Blessings	6,831
9	Karametra, God of Harvests	6,238
10	Jasmine Boreal of the Seven	5,991

Orzhov (WB)

#	Commander	Decks
1	Teysa Karlov	20,478
2	Eriette of the Charmed Apple	18,047
3	Liesa, Shroud of Dusk	12,257
4	Clavileño, First of the Blessed	10,235
5	Shilgengar, Sire of Famine	10,122
6	Ketramose, the New Dawn	9,401
7	Athreos, God of Passage	8,621
8	Brimaz, Blight of Oreskos	8,562
9	Zoraline, Cosmos Caller	8,228
10	Elas il-Kor, Sadistic Pilgrim	8,164

Izzet (UR)

#	Commander	Decks
1	Vivi Ornitier	33,418
2	Ghyrson Starn, Kelermorph	19,643
3	Niv-Mizzet, Parun	15,975
4	Stella Lee, Wild Card	13,545
5	Alania, Divergent Storm	11,130
6	Veyran, Voice of Duality	10,804
7	Captain Howler, Sea Scourge	10,578
8	Ovika, Enigma Goliath	10,540
9	Bria, Riptide Rogue	10,439
10	Okaun // Zndrsplt, Eye of Wisdom	9,477

Golgari (BG)

#	Commander	Decks
1	Lathril, Blade of the Elves	32,207
2	Chatterfang, Squirrel General	25,751
3	Ygra, Eater of All	22,395
4	Meren of Clan Nel Toth	21,028
5	High Perfect Morcant	14,661
6	Shelob, Child of Ungoliant	13,144

#	Commander	Decks
7	Hazel of the Rootbloom	12,505
8	Rendmaw, Creaking Nest	12,125
9	Witherbloom, the Balancer	11,621
10	The Gitrog Monster	9,296

Boros (RW)

#	Commander	Decks
1	Arabella, Abandoned Doll	20,320
2	Ragost, Deft Gastronomaut	15,989
3	Feather, the Redeemed	13,148
4	Winota, Joiner of Forces	12,913
5	Lightning, Army of One	12,224
6	The Jolly Balloon Man	11,030
7	Ardenn // Rograkh, Son of Rohgahh	8,029
8	Lorehold, the Historian	7,893
9	Mabel, Heir to Cragflame	7,211
10	Nahiri, Forged in Fury	6,789

Simic (GU)

#	Commander	Decks
1	Hakbal of the Surging Soul	23,772
2	Kinnan, Bonder Prodigy	19,530
3	Aesi, Tyrant of Gyre Strait	15,695
4	Omo, Queen of Vesuva	14,751
5	Zimone, Mystery Unraveler	14,563
6	Volo, Guide to Monsters	9,823
7	Tatyova, Benthic Druid	8,783
8	Clement, the Worrywort	8,433
9	Aloy, Savior of Meridian	8,339
10	Adrix and Nev, Twincasters	8,303

Bant (GWU)

#	Commander	Decks
1	Ms. Bumbleflower	33,832
2	Arcades, the Strategist	22,163
3	Helga, Skittish Seer	18,877
4	Tidus, Yuna's Guardian	17,283
5	Choco, Seeker of Paradise	17,137
6	Galadriel, Light of Valinor	14,933
7	Derevi, Empyrial Tactician	11,541
8	Chulane, Teller of Tales	9,220
9	Yuna, Grand Summoner	9,093
10	Brenard, Ginger Sculptor	8,790

Esper (WUB)

#	Commander	Decks
1	Y'shtola, Night's Blessed	42,938
2	Hashaton, Scarab's Fist	23,785
3	Oloro, Ageless Ascetic	20,508
4	Sidar Jabari of Zhalfir	17,669
5	Urza, Chief Artificer	16,481
6	Aminatou, Veil Piercer	16,309
7	Marneus Calgar	16,225
8	Alela, Artful Provocateur	15,807
9	Zur the Enchanter	15,676
10	Jin Sakai, Ghost of Tsushima	13,211

Grixis (UBR)

#	Commander	Decks
1	Sauron, the Dark Lord	33,813
2	Fire Lord Azula	30,964
3	Nekusar, the Mindrazer	29,863
4	Kefka, Court Mage	25,702
5	Obeka, Splitter of Seconds	17,236
6	Be'lakor, the Dark Master	14,786

#	Commander	Decks
7	Norman Osborn	14,544
8	Edward Kenway	13,490
9	Wick, the Whorled Mind	13,379
10	Inalla, Archmage Ritualist	13,125

Jund (BRG)

#	Commander	Decks
1	Hearthhull, the Worldseed	25,218
2	Korvold, Fae-Cursed King	19,884
3	Henzie “Toolbox” Torre	17,979
4	Auntie Ool, Cursewretch	15,461
5	Disa the Restless	13,589
6	Yurlok of Scorch Thrash	11,426
7	Indoraptor, the Perfect Hybrid	10,669
8	Ziatora, the Incinerator	10,244
9	Lord Windgrace	10,014
10	Coram, the Undertaker	9,632

Naya (RGW)

#	Commander	Decks
1	Pantlaza, Sun-Favored	33,291
2	Baylen, the Haymaker	28,822
3	Toph, the First Metalbender	26,226
4	Cloud, Ex-SOLDIER	25,275
5	Rin and Seri, Inseparable	21,958
6	Gishath, Sun’s Avatar	20,588
7	Atla Palani, Nest Tender	19,496
8	Voja, Jaws of the Conclave	18,043
9	Rocco, Street Chef	12,282
10	Jetmir, Nexus of Revels	9,640

Abzan (WBG)

#	Commander	Decks
1	The Necrobloom	24,656
2	Frodo, Adventurous Hobbit // Sam, Loyal Attendant	23,414
3	Felothar the Steadfast	17,559
4	Betor, Ancestor's Voice	16,048
5	Anikthea, Hand of Erebos	12,993
6	Thalia and The Gitrog Monster	11,747
7	Doran, Besieged by Time	10,227
8	Betor, Kin to All	8,704
9	Tayam, Luminous Enigma	8,313
10	Ghave, Guru of Spores	7,790

Jeskai (URW)

#	Commander	Decks
1	Zinnia, Valley's Voice	18,189
2	Satya, Aetherflux Genius	15,738
3	Kilo, Apogee Mind	15,583
4	Éowyn, Shieldmaiden	13,431
5	Kykar, Wind's Fury	13,411
6	Captain America, First Avenger	13,309
7	Zedruu the Greathearted	11,606
8	Inspirit, Flagship Vessel	10,843
9	Atreus, Impulsive Son // Kratos, Stoic Father	10,766
10	Narset, Enlightened Exile	10,495

Sultai (BGU)

#	Commander	Decks
1	Teval, the Balanced Scale	33,040
2	The Wise Mothman	31,462
3	Muldrotha, the Gravetide	23,561
4	Glarb, Calamity's Augur	22,473
5	Zaxara, the Exemplary	18,680
6	Maralen, Fae Ascendant	18,065

#	Commander	Decks
7	Kotis, the Fangkeeper	17,231
8	Yarok, the Desecrated	12,704
9	Gonti, Canny Acquisitor	11,308
10	Indominus Rex, Alpha	8,340

Mardu (RWB)

#	Commander	Decks
1	Edgar Markov	46,848
2	Kaalia of the Vast	37,303
3	Isshin, Two Heavens as One	28,459
4	Caesar, Legion's Emperor	21,573
5	Mr. House, President and CEO	21,453
6	Zurgo Stormrender	18,236
7	Queen Marchesa	17,192
8	Terra, Herald of Hope	15,846
9	Fire Lord Zuko	10,824
10	Dihada, Binder of Wills	10,734

Temur (GUR)

#	Commander	Decks
1	Miirym, Sentinel Wurm	27,334
2	Flubs, the Fool	23,640
3	Animar, Soul of Elements	22,373
4	Xyris, the Writhing Storm	18,889
5	Ureni of the Unwritten	18,696
6	Storm, Force of Nature	14,593
7	Magus Lucea Kane	14,390
8	Eshki, Temur's Roar	12,470
9	Iroh, Grand Lotus	12,381
10	Saheeli, Radiant Creator	8,966

Target Bracket: 2

Decks should be built to **Bracket 2** of the official Commander bracket system. This means:

- No game changers (as defined by the official bracket rules)
- No mass land destruction
- No extra turn spells as a primary strategy
- Decks aim for a fun, interactive game rather than a fast or oppressive win

Tutor Ban

Free tutoring undermines the creative constraint of the format. The following cards are banned in all decks:

- Demonic Tutor
- Vampiric Tutor
- Imperial Seal
- Grim Tutor
- Diabolic Tutor
- Dark Petition
- Mastermind's Acquisition
- Beseech the Mirror
- Worldly Tutor
- Sylvan Tutor
- Mystical Tutor
- Personal Tutor
- Solve the Equation
- Enlightened Tutor
- Entomb
- Gamble
- Scheming Symmetry
- Wishclaw Talisman

Tutors with a genuine constraint beyond card type are legal. A constraint means something that meaningfully limits the search — a CMC cap, a power/toughness restriction, a subtype, or a destination other than hand. Examples of legal tutors:

Card	Why it's legal
Trinket Mage	Artifact with CMC ≤ 1 only
Recruiter of the Guard	Creature with power ≤ 1 only
Fierce Empath	Creature with CMC ≥ 6 only
Buried Alive	Creatures only; goes to graveyard

Card	Why it's legal
Fauna Shaman	Creature; requires discarding a creature
Chord of Calling	Creature with CMC ≤ X
Finale of Devastation	Creature with CMC ≤ X

The Spirit of the Format

The rules exist to create interesting deckbuilding, not to be exploited. When in doubt, ask: *does this card let me ignore the creative constraint?* If yes, it probably shouldn't be in the deck.

The best games in this format come from unexpected commanders doing surprising things on a shoestring budget — not from someone optimizing around the edges of the rules.

Have fun, brew something weird, and show what 65 € can do.